APPENDIX · FOR Q&A

Appendix

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Back to the main deck. Everything shown is fictional or simulated. Eligibility labels are demo rules, not an official determination.

APPENDIX · A1

Sources

TEMA, January 2026 Winter Weather
tn.gov/tema/assistance/active-disasters-and-emergencies/2026-disasters/january-2026-winter-weather.html

TDLWD, DUA in 29 counties (Apr 22, 2026)
tn.gov/workforce/general-resources/news/2026/4/22/disaster-unemployment-assistance-available-in-29-tennessee-counties.html

TDLWD, Disaster Unemployment page
tn.gov/workforce/unemployment/disaster-unemployment.html

TDLWD, DUA documentation requirements (2025 release)
tn.gov/workforce/general-resources/news/2025/6/26/disaster-unemployment-assistance-available-in-nine-counties.html

WKRN, FEMA IA added for 29 counties
wkrn.com/news/tennessee-news/tennessees-winter-storm-disaster-declaration-amended-to-include-fema-individual-assistance/amp/

WSMV, IA deadline (May 13, 2026)
wsmv.com/2026/05/13/tennesseans-affected-by-deadly-january-winter-storm-have-less-than-one-month-apply-disaster-assistance-tema-says/

WVLT, FEMA approvals (Jun 9, 2026)
wvlt.tv/2026/06/09/deadline-apply-disaster-assistance-tn-ice-storm-is-this-week/

ABC News 4, NES outages (57,000)
abcnews4.com/news/nation-world/gallery/nashville-power-outages-nes-electric-service-customers-still-without-power-nearly-week-after-ice-storm-winter-weather

NewsChannel 9, NES outages (22,000)
newschannel9.com/news/local/gallery/nashville-power-outages-25000-nes-electric-services-customers-without-power-more-than-a-week-after-ice-storm-winter-weather

GAO-20-503, FEMA Individuals and Households Program (Sept 30, 2020)
gao.gov/products/gao-20-503

GOV.UK Design System (patterns only, no branding)
design-system.service.gov.uk

Map data
US Census cartographic boundaries (county shapes). Esri Light Gray basemap (tiles).

APPENDIX · A2 (1 OF 2)

Verified facts: the storm and the programs

FACT	WHAT WE STATE	SOURCE
Winter Storm Fern	Severe winter storms began Jan 22, 2026. The ice storm hit Middle Tennessee Jan 24. Federal disaster declaration FEMA DR-4898.	TEMA
FEMA Individual Assistance	Added for 29 Tennessee counties more than two months after the storm. Deadline to apply was June 10, 2026.	WKRN, WSMV
Disaster Unemployment Assistance (DUA)	TDLWD opened DUA for 29 counties on April 22, 2026, with applications open until June 9, 2026. Computed: Jan 24 to Apr 22 is 88 days.	TDLWD
How to apply	Through Jobs4TN. State unemployment first: select “Lack of Work,” then “Disaster related closure.” DUA applications come after, if the county is approved.	TDLWD
DUA documents	Due within 21 days of filing: SSN, most recent federal income tax form or paycheck stubs, and documentation showing the person was working or self-employed when the disaster occurred.	TDLWD (2025 release)
DUA vs regular unemployment	DUA is a federal program administered by the state. Regular unemployment and DUA cannot be paid at the same time.	TDLWD

APPENDIX · A2 (2 OF 2)

Verified facts: impact and the forms burden

FACT	WHAT WE STATE	SOURCE
Power outages	NES reported 57,000 customers still without power nearly a week after the storm, and 22,000 still out more than a week after.	ABC News 4, NewsChannel 9
Relief that came	FEMA approved about $23.7 million for 10,563 households in May 2026.	WVLT
Applicants, 2016 to 2018	5.6 million people applied for FEMA disaster assistance (4.4 million referred to the Individuals and Households Program).	GAO-20-503, Sept 30, 2020
Survivor confusion	FEMA, state, territory, and local officials reported that survivors “did not understand and were frustrated by” the SBA loan requirement.	GAO-20-503, Sept 30, 2020
Not used	The GAO page gives two different counts of ineligible applicants (about 1.7 million and about 2.4 million) and does not reconcile them, so we do not quote either.	GAO-20-503
Not verified, never stated	The exact screens of the live Jobs4TN claim flow. Current mailing or fax for documents. Whether any specific person qualifies. Any statistic not on this page.	n/a

GAO items were added after the original brief and read from the GAO product page on Nov 6, 2026.

APPENDIX · A3

The 29 counties in the FEMA IA and DUA declarations

- Benton
- Carroll
- Cheatham
- Chester
- Clay
- Davidson
- Decatur
- Dickson
- Dyer
- Fayette
- Hardeman
- Hardin
- Henderson
- Hickman
- Lewis
- Macon
- Madison
- Maury
- McNairy
- Montgomery
- Perry
- Robertson
- Rutherford
- Shelby
- Sumner
- Trousdale
- Wayne
- Williamson
- Wilson

Source: TEMA via WKRN, April 2026. All 95 counties were designated for FEMA public assistance or emergency protective measures. The team still plans to cross-check this list against TEMA directly.

APPENDIX · A4

How the eligibility rules work

The AI extracts facts from what the caller says. A small rules module, not the AI, decides the label. These are demo rules, not an official determination.

```
declared = the caller's county is one of the 29 declared counties

Disaster Unemployment Assistance
  declared AND income loss AND not retired        →  Likely eligible   (due June 9, 2026)

FEMA Individual Assistance
  declared AND (uninsured loss OR housing need OR debris need)
                                                  →  Likely eligible   (due June 10, 2026)

SBA disaster loan
  declared AND (uninsured loss OR housing need)   →  Possibly eligible  (check SBA's current terms)

Local resources                                   →  Available
```

Every label says likely or possibly, never “approved,” and links back to the program's own rules. The same facts always give the same label, so results are predictable and explainable.

APPENDIX · A5

Architecture and tools

LAYER	WHAT IT IS TODAY
Web app	React, Vite, Leaflet.
Hearing the caller	Browser speech recognition (Chrome, needs internet) for live transcription on screen.
The AI voice	Text-to-speech. Voice lines are pre-generated and cached on disk, with the browser voice as a fallback, so the demo can run offline.
The phone	A simulated handset: the caller's speech and keypad taps travel over the web to the demo screen instead of through a phone carrier. Production would use Twilio voice and SMS.
Conversation	Scripted by intent for the demo. The AI's questions and the form values are pre-written, and the caller can phrase answers any way.
Eligibility	A rules module decides labels and deadlines (see A4).
Map	US Census county boundaries, Esri Light Gray basemap, about 50 seeded simulated callers labeled simulated everywhere.
Roadmap	Claude for real conversation and fact extraction. Live monitoring of declarations. Twilio voice and SMS. State and county responder dashboards.

APPENDIX · A6

Privacy and identity

Privacy

SSN and date of birth are **never spoken**. They are typed into a masked field or on the keypad.

Map pins are at county or neighborhood level, **never exact home addresses**.

Names and phone numbers show only for callers who **opted in**.

The public aggregate view shows **counts only**.

Identity on the call

The call comes from the **number on file**, but caller ID alone is not trusted.

The caller proves it with **date of birth and ZIP typed on the keypad**, shown only as dots. Wrong answers are rejected.

Typed keypad entry keeps sensitive numbers out of the voice channel and the transcript.

Something you have (your phone number) plus something you know. Production would add a **texted one-time code** and lock the account after repeated failures.

APPENDIX · A7

Judge Q&A

What if cell towers are down?

Messages are queued and sent as soon as the person has signal again. The pre-disaster profile means very little has to be said in a bad moment.

Do you submit applications?

No. We prepare, the survivor reviews and submits. There is no real integration with any government system.

Is this an official eligibility decision?

No. Labels say “likely eligible” using simple demo rules, with links to the program rules.

How do you stop someone calling as somebody else?

The call must come from the number on file, then the caller proves identity with date of birth and ZIP typed on the keypad, never spoken. Wrong answers are rejected. Production adds a texted one-time code and lockout after failed attempts.

What about privacy?

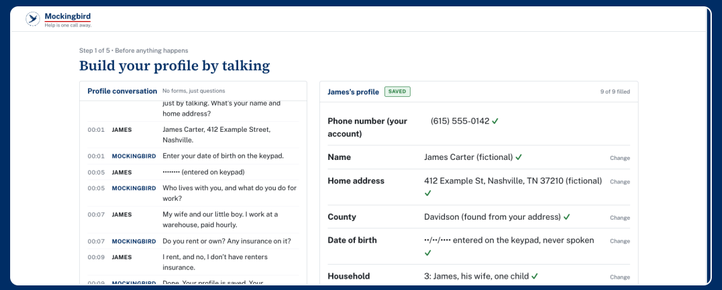
SSN and date of birth are never spoken. The map is county level, names show only with opt-in, and the public view is counts only.

How does the AI avoid making things up?

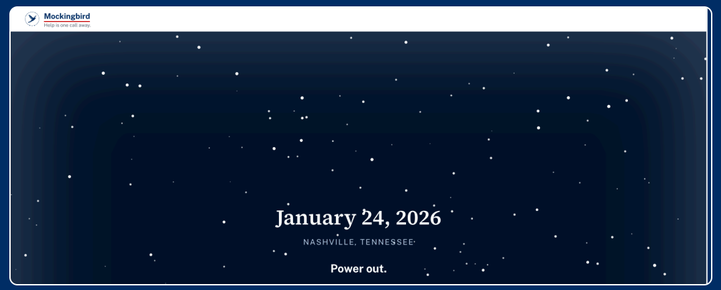
The AI extracts facts. A rules module decides eligibility labels and deadlines. The AI never says “approved.”

APPENDIX · A8

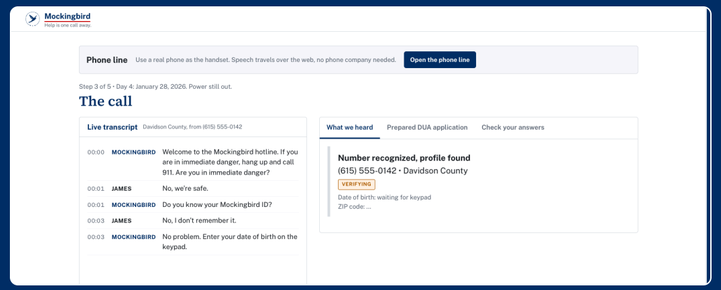
Backup: the demo screens



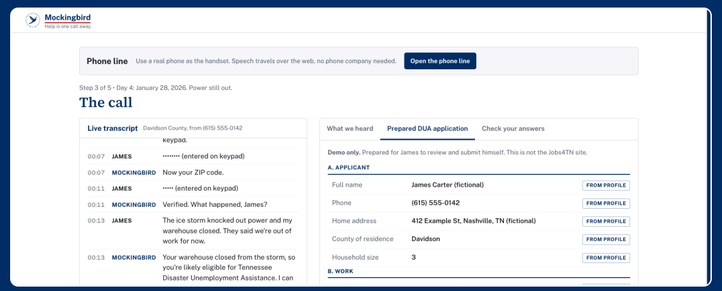
1 Profile: complete, ready to pre-fill



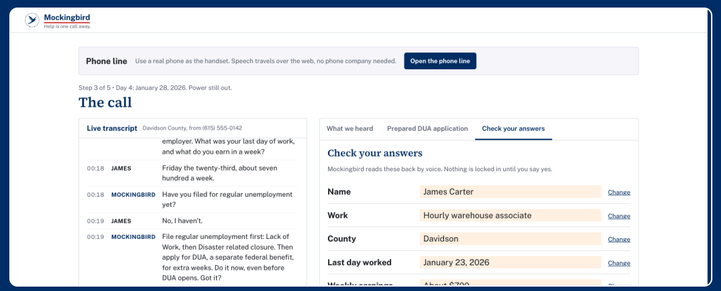
2 Storm: the title card



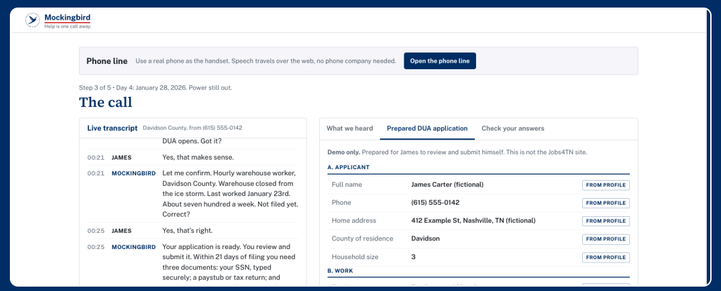
3 Call: identity on the keypad



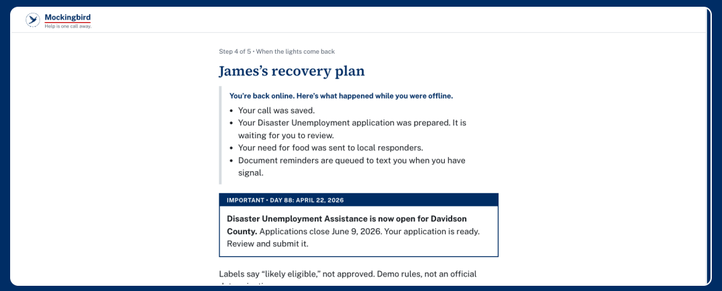
3 Call: likely eligible, form fills in



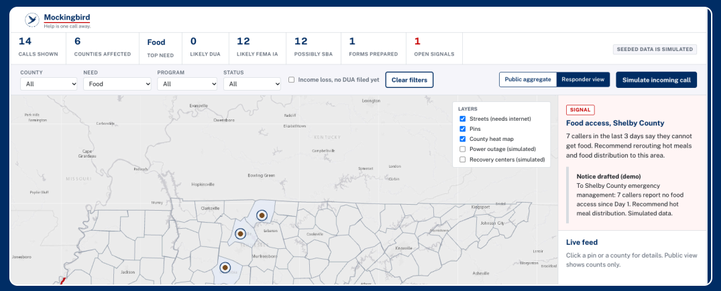
3 Call: check your answers



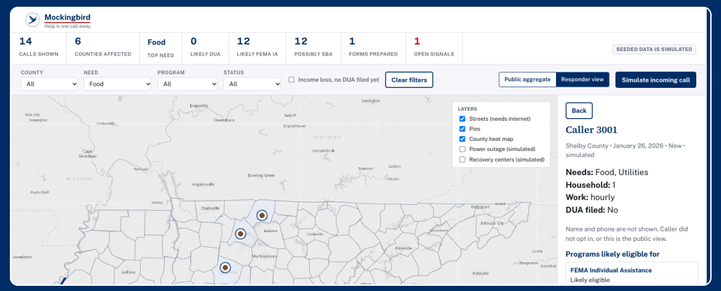
3 Call: documents and the 21-day warning



4 Plan: tasks in three time windows



5 Map: the food signal and area notice



5 Map: an anonymized caller card

Captured from the running demo. All people and callers are fictional or simulated.